LESSON 8

London Bridge

An old English singing game: two children make a bridge with their arms, and it falls down on whoever is passing under.

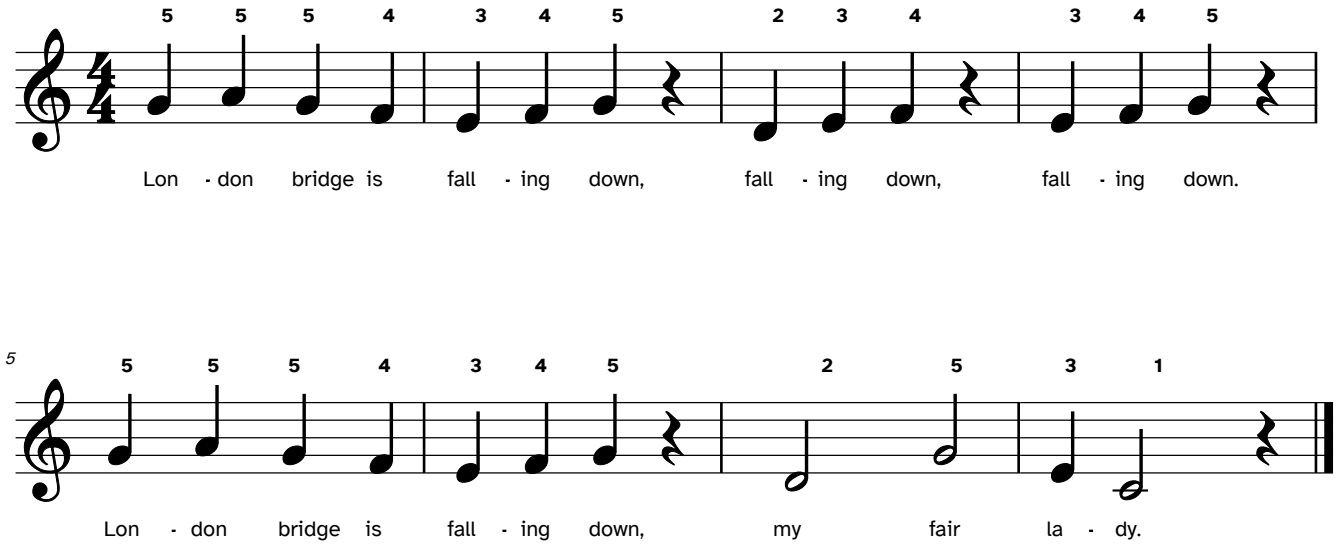
LISTEN FIRST
Scan the code: listen once, then hum along.

THE WOW MOMENT
The bridge falls: on every rest the right hand jumps off the keys, high in the air, and lands back in place for the next bar.

1 Meet the song

Listen, pointing to each note. Sing it, then play the tune with the right hand: lift on every rest.

Right hand: the C position; on *Lon-don* 5 reaches up to A and straight back. The left hand joins on page 3, from the names.



- [ ] Listened and pointed
- [ ] Lifted on every rest
- [ ] Played the tune

2 Take it apart

The same song, one piece at a time: first its rhythm, then its notes.

NEW IN THIS SONG

Rests. A crotchet rest is one beat of silence: count it, but don't play. **A second root, G.** The left hand plays C or G at the start of each bar, whichever the tune leans on. **No letters now:** read the notes from the staff.

THE RHYTHM

Say the words in time, then clap and count: clap on the coral numbers, hold through the grey ones, and on a rest's grey number lift your hands.

THE TIME

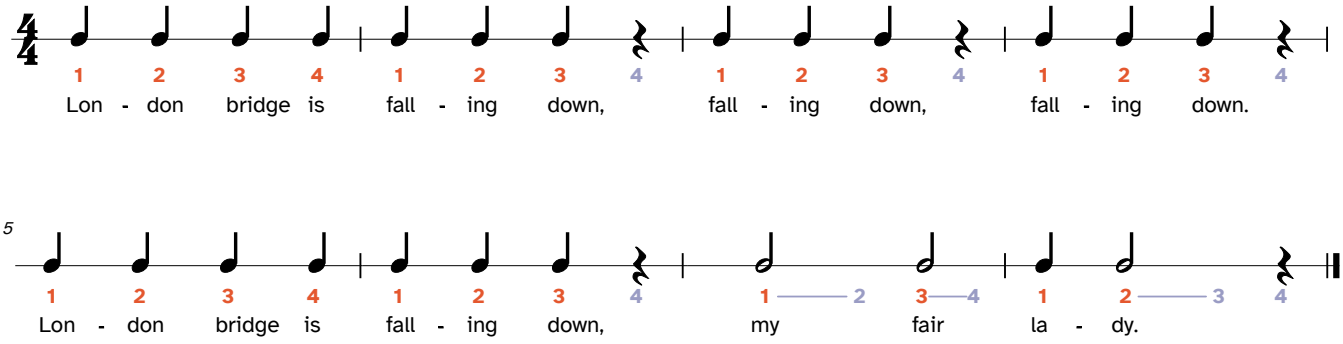
Top 4: four beats in every bar.
Bottom 4: a crotchet is one beat.

THE NOTES

crotchet: walk — 1 beat

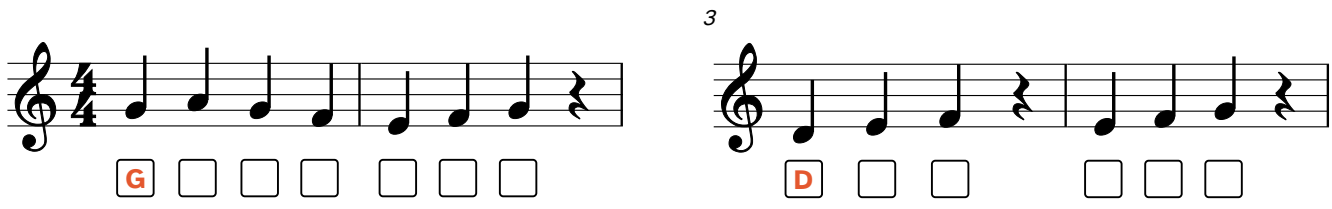
crotchet rest: knock — 1 beat

minim: hold — 2 beats



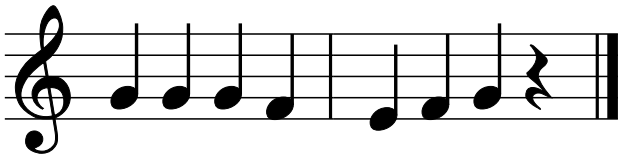
THE NOTES

The letters are gone now. The first note of each line is given: count up or down from it.



SPOT THE MISTAKE

One note here is wrong. Play it, then the same bars on page 1: which note sounds wrong? Circle it.



- [ ] **Said it in time**
- [ ] **Clapped and counted**
- [ ] **Wrote the letter names**
- [ ] **Spotted the mistake**

3 Lead sheet

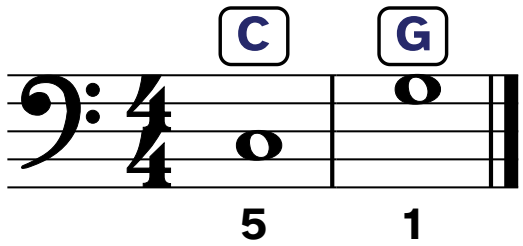
The tune and its names, C and G. Your left hand plays pattern 2 from the names: hold each bar's root.

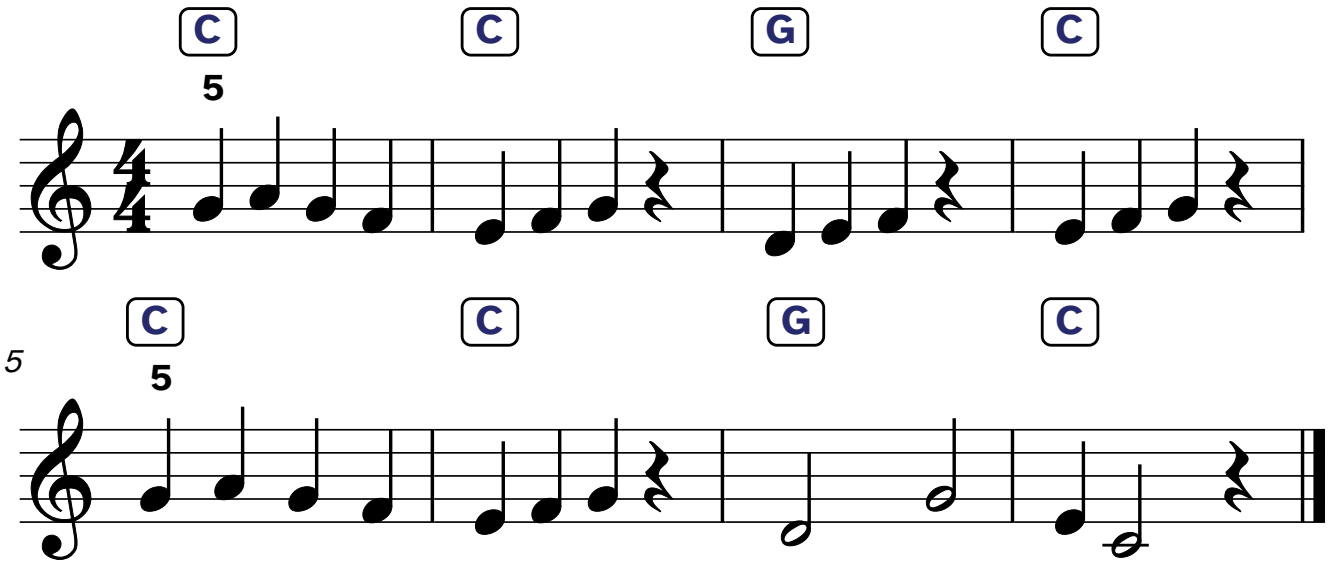
PATTERN 2 · THE ROOT CHANGES

Held, as in Lesson 7; now watch the name.

C: 5 on low C. G: the thumb on G.

C G





1 Tune alone, right hand

2 Pattern alone, reading only the names

3 Together, slowly, then with the band

4 · CHECK

I can play it: colour a step each time you climb

	Slowly	Steady	With the band	Fast
The tune				
With the pattern				
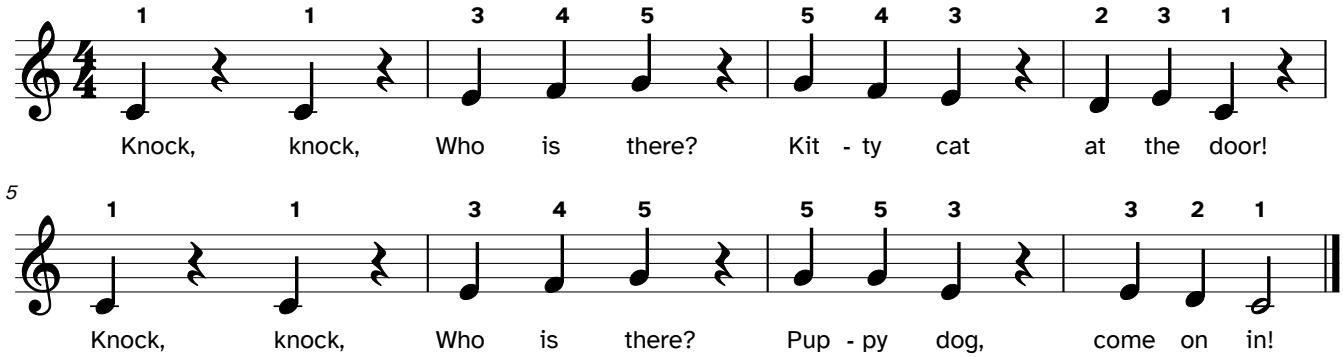
LISTEN BACK ☐ **I recorded it** ☐ **It sounded right**

+ More to play

Use what this lesson taught in new ways, then take a first look at the next lesson.

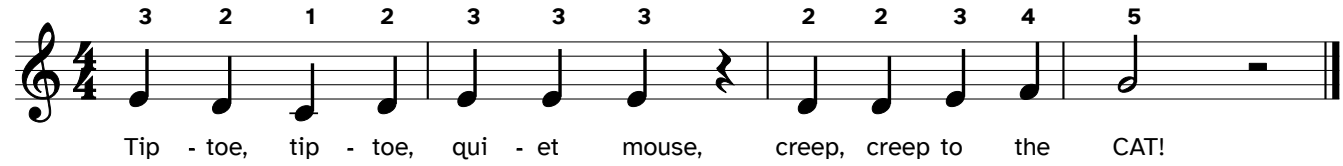
KNOCK, KNOCK

Cheeky: the right hand plays, and the left hand is the door knocker: it knocks on the lid on every rest.



TIPTOE

A peek at Lesson 9: soft, softer… then the last note loud.



MAKE IT YOURS

Pick one and play the whole song that way. Record it on a phone and listen back: does it sound the way you meant?

- ☐ **Falling slowly: slow and soft**
- ☐ **Bouncy: short and light, like a ball**
- ☐ **Verse 2, "Build it up with iron bars": the root on every beat 1**

5 MINUTES AT HOME

1. Listen to the song once
2. The tune, right hand
3. Pattern 2 from the names (page 3)
4. Both hands, with the band

☐ M ☐ T ☐ W ☐ T ☐ F ☐ S ☐ S

☐ **Played Knock, Knock** ☐ **Played Tiptoe**